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Efficacy and Safety of Dermacalm in Moderate atopic dermatitis: A Phase 3 Randomised, Double-Blind, Placebo-Controlled Trial

Authors: Kumar A, Chen B, Iyer C et al. **Trial registration:** SYN-NCT-2858494

Note: Entirely fictional study with invented drug and data, created for training. Do not use for clinical decisions.

Abstract

Background: Dermacalm (DMC) is a topical JAK1-selective inhibitor under investigation for moderate atopic dermatitis. **Methods:** In this multicentre trial, 567 adults were randomised 1:1 to Dermacalm or placebo for 52 weeks, stratified by baseline severity and region. The primary endpoint was EASI-75 response at week 8. **Results:** The primary endpoint was 58.0 with Dermacalm versus 24.0 with placebo (p 0.003). Application-site burning occurred in 9.1% of Dermacalm patients and 4.7% of placebo patients. **Conclusions:** Dermacalm met its primary endpoint with a manageable safety profile in moderate atopic dermatitis.

Methods

Eligible participants were aged 18 to 75 years with a confirmed diagnosis of moderate atopic dermatitis and provided written informed consent. Exclusion criteria included pregnancy, severe hepatic impairment (Child-Pugh C), and concurrent use of strong CYP3A4 inducers. Randomisation used an interactive web-response system. The analysis followed the intention-to-treat principle with multiple imputation for missing data.

Results

Characteristic	Dermacalm	Placebo
Participants (n)	283	284
Mean age (years)	61.0	58.7
Female (%)	41	38
Primary endpoint	58.0	24.0
p-value	0.003	-
Application-site burning (%)	9.1	4.7
Discontinuation due to AE (%)	2.9	2.1

Serious adverse events were reported in 5.4% of the Dermacalm group and 5.7% of the placebo group. There were 6 deaths in the Dermacalm arm and 6 in the placebo arm, none judged related to study treatment.

Discussion

The effect size observed with Dermacalm is clinically meaningful. Limitations include the 52-week duration, under-representation of patients aged over 75 years, and limited ethnic diversity. Long-term safety beyond one year requires an open-label extension, which is ongoing.

References

1. Synthetic reference list omitted. 2. Illustrative Guidelines on Management, 2025.